

Massachusetts Cultural Resource Information System

Scanned Record Cover Page

Inventory No:	CUM.151
Historic Name:	Gurney, Asa House
Common Name:	
Address:	75 Mount Rd
City/Town:	Cummington
Village/Neighborhood:	
Local No:	412;
Year Constructed:	1808
Architectural Style(s):	Colonial; No style;
Use(s):	Agricultural; Single Family Dwelling House;
Significance:	Agriculture; Architecture;
Area(s):	
Designation(s):	
Building Materials:	Wall: Wood; Wood Clapboard;
Demolished	No



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Commonwealth of Massachusetts
Massachusetts Historical Commission
220 Morrissey Boulevard, Boston, Massachusetts 02125
www.sec.state.ma.us/mhc

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FORM B - BUILDING

MASSACHUSETTS HISTORICAL COMMISSION
Office of the Secretary, State House, Boston

CUM. 151

In Area no.

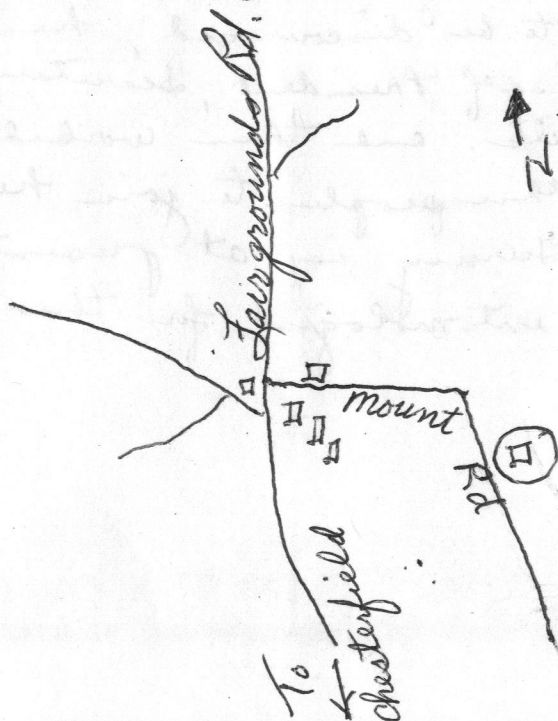
Form no.

E

412
151



4. Map. Draw sketch of building location in relation to nearest cross streets and other buildings. Indicate north.



DO NOT WRITE IN THIS SPACE
USGS Quadrant _____

MHC Photo no. _____

Location Cummington

Address 75 Mount Rd.

Name Harriet Gurney

Present use dwelling

Present owner Harriet Gurney

Description:

Year 1808

Source Only one Cummington

Structure 1 1/2 story wood frame

Architect Cape Cod

Exterior wall fabric clapboard

Outbuildings (describe) barn

Other features all - two story

Altered _____ Date _____

Moved _____ Date _____

5. Lot size:

One acre or less _____ Over one acre ☒

Approximate frontage over 1000'

Approximate distance of building from street

75

6. Recorded by W.W.S.

Organization Cummington Hist Comm

Date 1-30-75

RECEIVED

(over) B 14 1975

MASS. HIST. COMM.

original owner Asa Gurney
original use dwelling

com. 151

Agriculture ✓
Community Development ✓
Science ✓

No. 412
Lots No. 5 & 6 PL
Harriet Gurney

This is the oldest homestead in the town that is still in the original family name. Benjamin Gurney first purchased land in Lot No. 59-1 on November 5, 1770. The records indicate that in 1787 Benjamin Gurney and Philip Shaw purchased each other's farms. Gurney moved to the village (No. 404) to 100 acres of the southerly part of Minot Grant, while Shaw moved to the hill (No. 302) in Lot No 59-1. In 1795 Asa Gurney purchased the southerly half of Lot No. 5 PL and the northerly half of Lot No. 6 PL from the Commonwealth of Massachusetts. He probably built a log cabin first as it is said he built the present house in 1808.

The Gurneys owned land in the village and as an incentive to the development of Main Street offered a free acre of land to anyone who would build a house there. Some of the houses are said to be Nos. 223, 226, 227, 228. It is believed there were other

John Wesley Gurney was interested in having the Hillside Agricultural Society incorporated so that it could buy a permanent fairground. He called a meeting but no one else came. Not to be discouraged, he named himself President, Secretary, Treasurer, etc. and then worked at getting other people to join him. Ashley Gurney is at present a retired entomologist for the U.S. Gov't.

Sources:

Only One Cummington

Deeds

Tax Records